14.10 Poisoning and Drug Overdose*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Family found him with empty tablet bottles **Objective** • RR 8/min, shallow • SpO_2 86% • Pinpoint pupils	**ACTUAL** Ineffective breathing pattern related to central nervous system depression as evidenced by bradypnea and hypoxemia.	• RR 12–20/min and SpO_2 94% or above.	• Open the airway and ventilate with a bag-valve-mask if needed. • Give the prescribed antidote, for example naloxone for opioids. • Keep RR, SpO_2 and consciousness on continuous watch. • Contact the poison information service per policy. • Send drug levels as ordered.	• Considered met when breathing is adequate.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • GCS 10 • Disoriented on waking	**ACTUAL** Acute confusion related to toxic effects of the ingested substance as evidenced by reduced GCS and disorientation.	• Back to his usual orientation.	• Check GCS often. • Keep him safe and under close observation. • Once alert, assess intent and refer to the mental health team.	• Goal reached when he is oriented and has been referred.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Reduced consciousness • Vomiting	**RISK** Risk for aspiration as evidenced by risk factors: decreased level of consciousness and vomiting.	• Airway clear, no aspiration.	• Place him in the recovery position. • Keep suction ready. • Nil by mouth until he is alert.	• Met if aspiration does not occur.

*References for this care plan: [31], [35], [101], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.